

**Monaca, PA – Ohio River Brownfields Redevelopment Planning
Federal/State/Regional Partners Meeting**

June 5, 2012; 3-4pm EDT

Conference call-in #: 1-866-299-3188

Conference code: 202 566 0633#

Meeting Agenda

1. Introductions (5 min)
2. Short background on the Brownfields Area Wide Planning program
Aimee Storm, Tish Corbett and Marie Holman, US EPA - 5 min
 - a. EPA interest in area wide planning for brownfields
 - b. Getting other federal, state and regional agencies involved and working together
3. Overview of Borough of Monaca and partner communities Ohio River Brownfields project
Mario Leone, Borough of Monaca and Sean Garrigan, Stromberg/Garrigan & Associates – 25 min
 - a. Project design and goals
 - b. Already identified/stand-out issues and linkages to Ohio River Trail development, road transportation & transit, community facilities, water quality improvements, economic development
 - c. Site reuse plans & related infrastructure needs
 - d. Project schedule, upcoming community meetings
4. Participants Discussion (30 min)
 - Working together will help Monaca and partner communities revitalize contaminated sites & surrounding area
 - Are there other ongoing federal, state, or regional efforts in the Ohio River Corridor as it relates to partner communities?
 - Where are the opportunities to be working together?
 - Are there other agencies or organizations that might be interested in this project?
 - Finding local, regional, state and federal funding
 - Are there upcoming grant funding or technical assistance opportunities which may be appropriate to help Monaca and partner communities implement this project?
 - What types of program resources might these communities be eligible for?
 - Getting involved and staying updated: future involvement opportunities (community meetings, draft/final report), website

MONACA U.S. EPA AREA-WIDE BROWNFIELDS PROJECT

Project Briefing Presentation

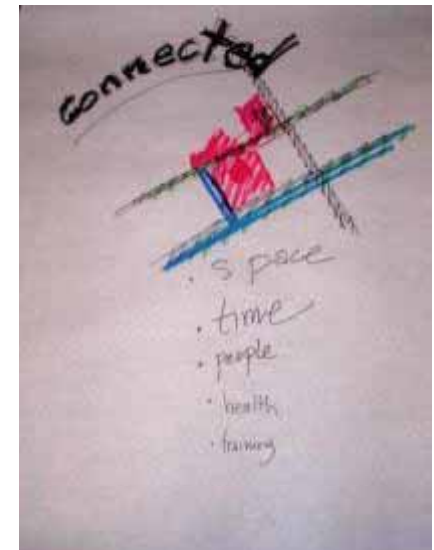
June 5, 2012



A regional brownfields planning effort lead by Monaca Borough in partnership with Midland Borough, the City of Aliquippa, the Borough of Coraopolis and the Ohio River Trail Council

EPA Brownfields Area-Wide Planning Pilots Overview

- New EPA program in 2010:
 - Research planning and implementation strategies related to brownfields cleanup & reuse
 - Focus on key sites and surrounding area
- Grant assistance given for:
 - Evaluating existing conditions
 - Identifying community priorities
 - Developing brownfields area-wide plan (provides a framework for improving area economic, social & environmental conditions;) and
 - Identifying resources or leveraging opportunities to help implement plans
- 23 pilots selected
16 local governments, 5 nonprofits, 1 tribe, 1 regional planning commission



BF AWP Program Context

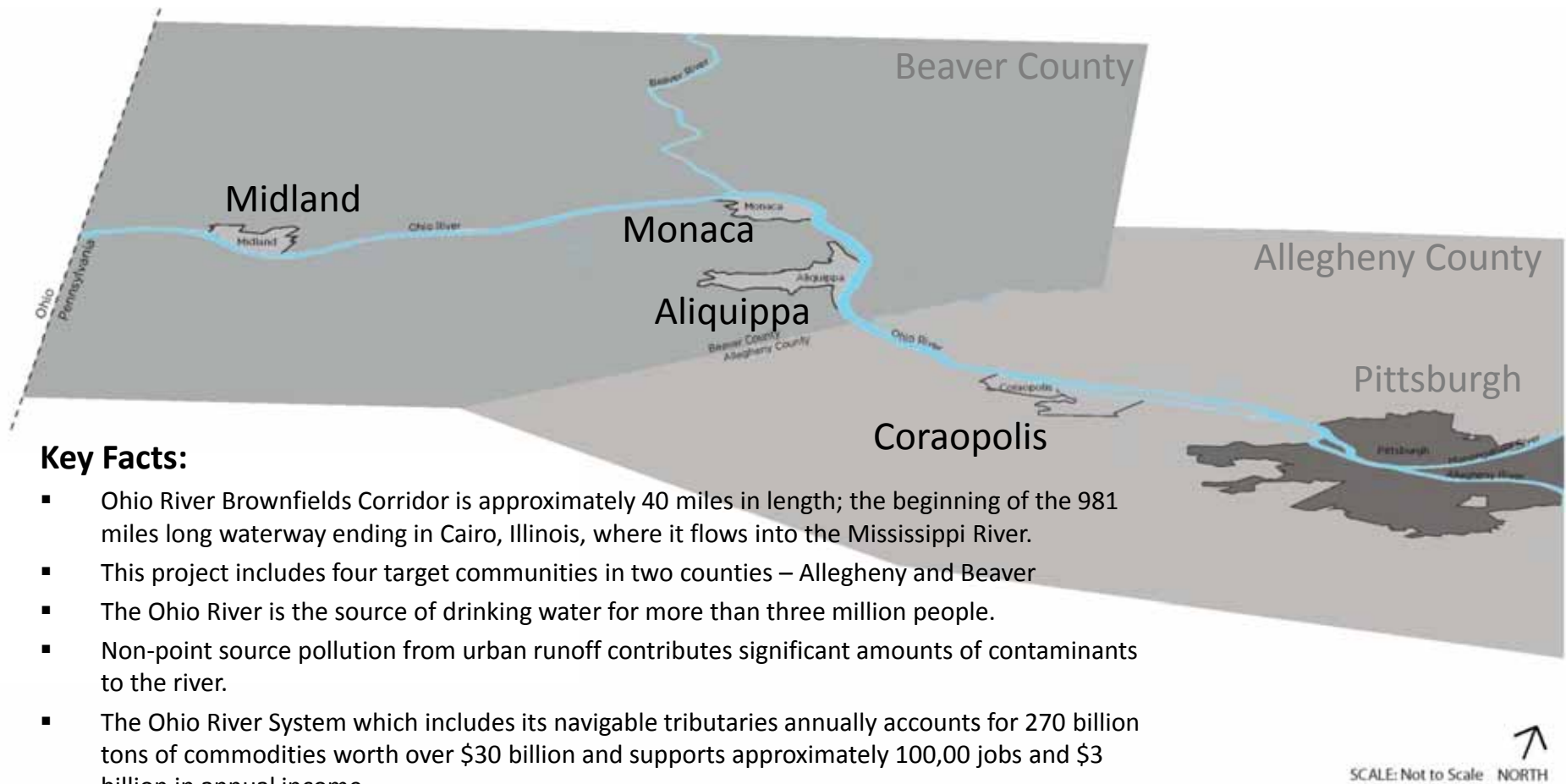
- Multiple sites are often connected by ***proximity*** and ***infrastructure***
- Brownfields limit the economic, social and environmental prosperity of surroundings
 - Area revitalization is ***critical to the successful long-term reuse of the brownfields***
 - Approaching brownfields from area perspective can be more effective than a site-by-site
- Coordinating across federal, state, and regional entities is a key component of the program
 - BF AWP program is part of the HUD-DOT-EPA [Partnership for Sustainable Communities](#)
 - Power in convening; & working together to transportation, recreation, jobs, housing & other land use to achieve economic, environmental goals



Partnerships and Leveraging for the Ohio River Brownfields Corridor project

- Working together will help the Borough of Monaca and partner communities Borough of Midland, Coraopolis, and City of Aliquippa revitalize contaminated sites & surrounding area along Ohio River
 - Are there other ongoing federal or local efforts in the Ohio River Corridor/nearby communities? Where are the opportunities to be working together?
 - Are there other agencies or organizations that might be interested in this project?
- Finding local, regional, state & federal funding
 - Which upcoming grant funding or technical assistance opportunities which may be appropriate to help Monaca and partner communities implement this project?
 - What types of program resources might these communities be eligible for?
- Getting involved and staying updated: Future involvement opportunities (community meetings, draft/final report), website
 - Monaca contact: Mario Leone, Borough Manager for Monaca, PA
 - EPA contacts: Aimee Storm (HQ Brownfields office); Tish Corbett & Marie Holman (Region 3 Land Revitalization & Partnership for Sustainable Communities)

The Ohio River Brownfields Corridor



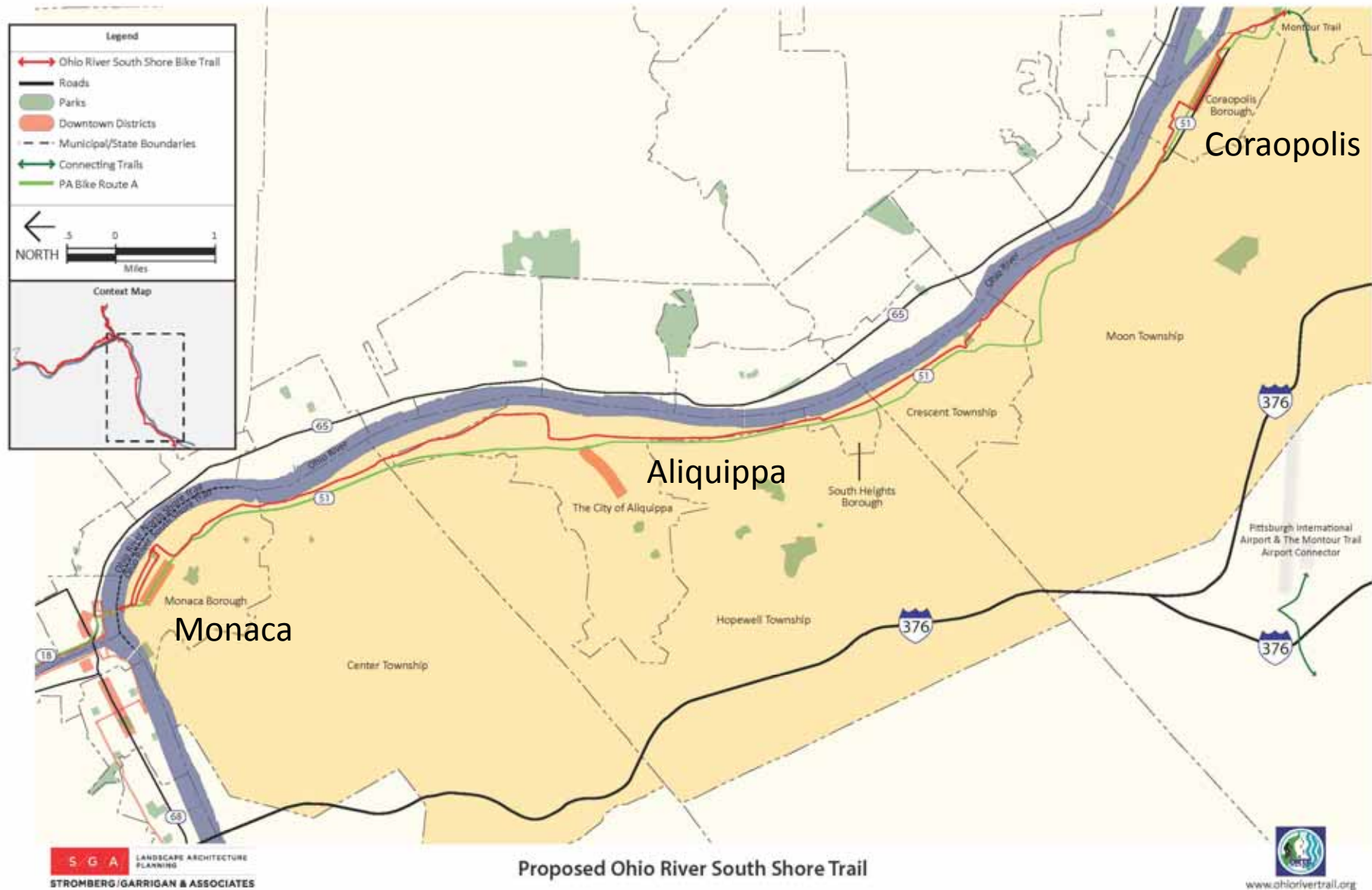
Key Facts:

- Ohio River Brownfields Corridor is approximately 40 miles in length; the beginning of the 981 miles long waterway ending in Cairo, Illinois, where it flows into the Mississippi River.
- This project includes four target communities in two counties – Allegheny and Beaver
- The Ohio River is the source of drinking water for more than three million people.
- Non-point source pollution from urban runoff contributes significant amounts of contaminants to the river.
- The Ohio River System which includes its navigable tributaries annually accounts for 270 billion tons of commodities worth over \$30 billion and supports approximately 100,00 jobs and \$3 billion in annual income.
- Although this stretch has suffered from major steel plant closings since the late 1970s there is a significant amount of existing and new industrial activity including steel plants, specialty manufacturing and major new investment as a result of the shale gas industry and new technology businesses (PACyber) and the proposed Shell Ethanol (Cracker) Refinery.

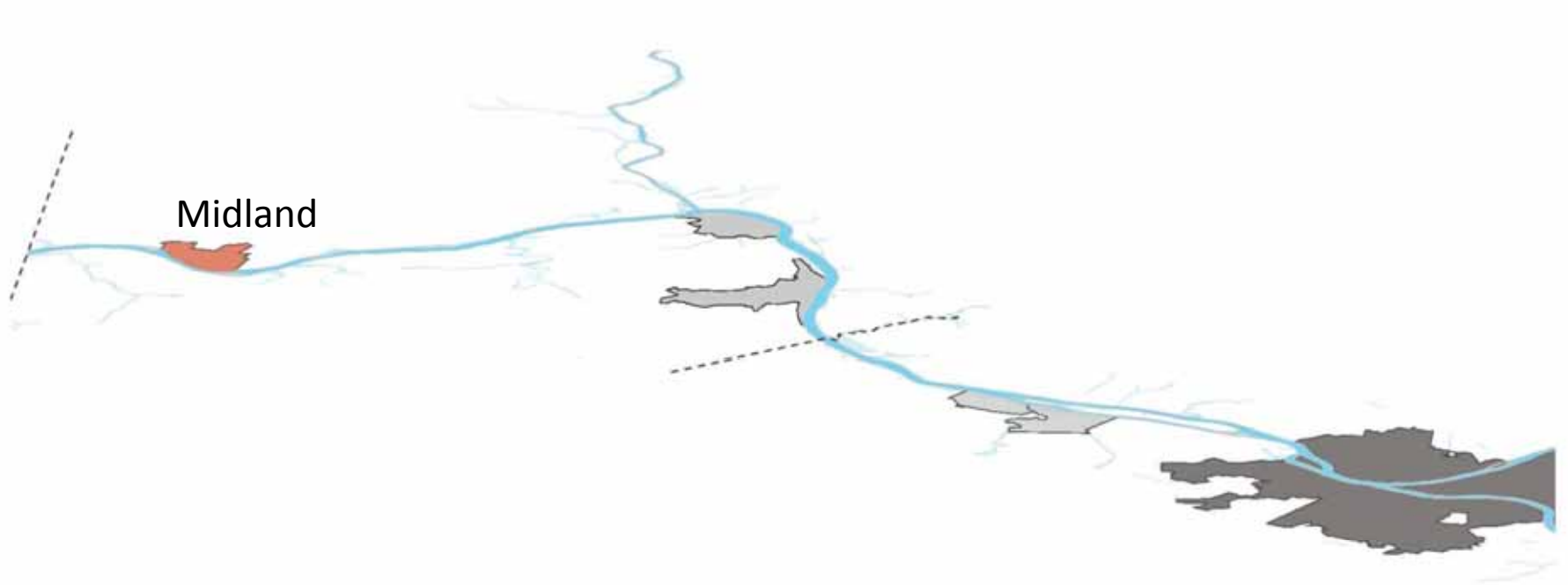
The Ohio River Trail Corridor



The Ohio River Trail Corridor



Midland Borough



Midland Borough

Analysis Conclusions

- Active steel plants and support industries generate truck traffic that creates conflicts with PACyber School expansion and major “main street infill redevelopment along Midland Avenue.
- Private developers interested in several block long infill redevelopments along western end of Midland Avenue requires support infrastructure, especially parking.
- Part of the proposed Ohio River Trail connection through the Borough travels along Railroad Avenue
- Stormwater management and pre-treatment areas are needed.

Planning Proposals and Priority Projects

- Create proposed Steel Way as a new “green street” to create truck route access from the east Route 68 to main gate of Allegheny Ludlum plant to remove the majority of truck traffic from Midland Avenue through the center of town.
- Redevelop west end Railroad Avenue parcel from 3rd to 4th Avenue for public parking lot.
- Upgrade Railroad Avenue as a green alleyway to support Ohio River Trail and provide rain gardens at street end parks.

Midland – West

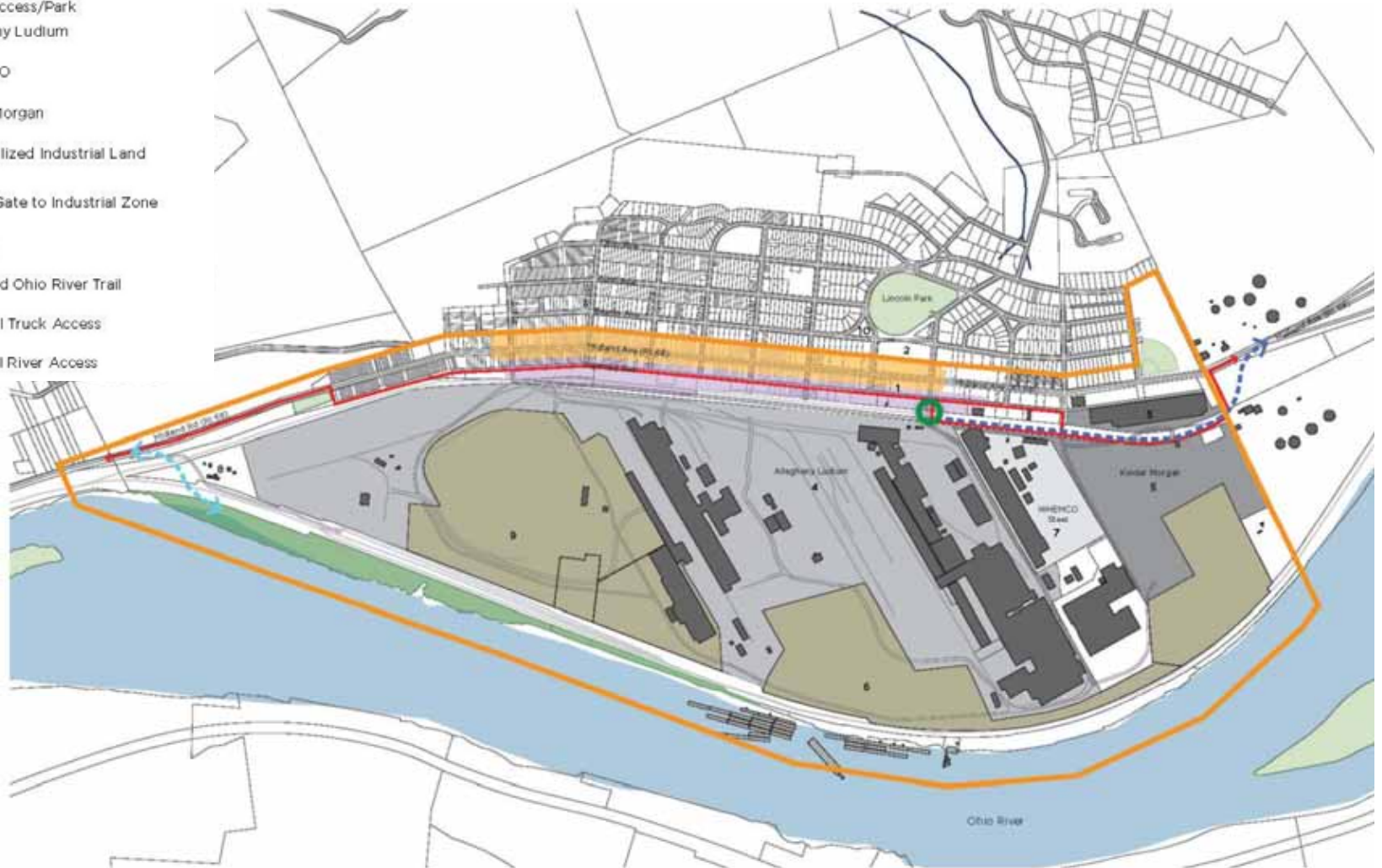


Midland – East



LEGEND

- Traditional Main Street
Redevelopment Corridor
- Economic Development
Infrastructure Corridor
- Potential Riverfront
Public Access/Park
- Allegheny Ludlum
- WHEMCO
- Kinder Morgan
- Underutilized Industrial Land
- Access Gate to Industrial Zone
- Railroad
- Proposed Ohio River Trail
- Potential Truck Access
- Potential River Access



SCALE: Not to Scale NORTH

Midland – East

Proposed Steel Way “green street”



Allegheny Ludlum
Steel Main Gate

Midland



Midland

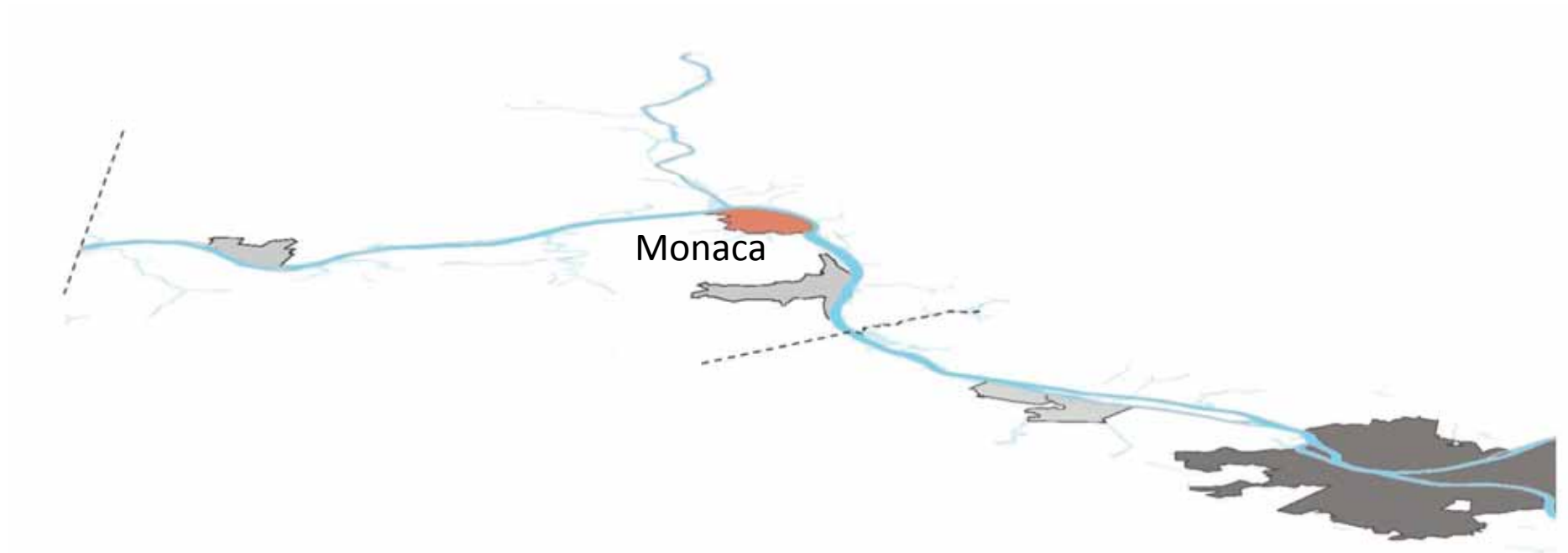


Proposed parking lot to support infill redevelopment with stormwater management/rain gardens

Midland



Monaca Borough



Monaca Borough

Analysis Conclusions

- Former Colona Steel plant has a specialty metals fabricator but the bulk of the site is vacant and is located at key location on the river and is adjacent to residential neighborhoods. Property is owned by development company based in NJ.
- East Rochester – Monaca Bridge access divides neighborhood context and the intersection of 17th Avenue and Pennsylvania Avenue is confusing and hinders economic development.
- Part of the proposed Ohio River Trail connection through the Borough travels through Colona Steel site area.
- Potential for McClymonds transfer coal facility to close.
- Industrial area has poor vehicular access and circulation.
- Stormwater management and pre-treatment areas are needed (CSO).

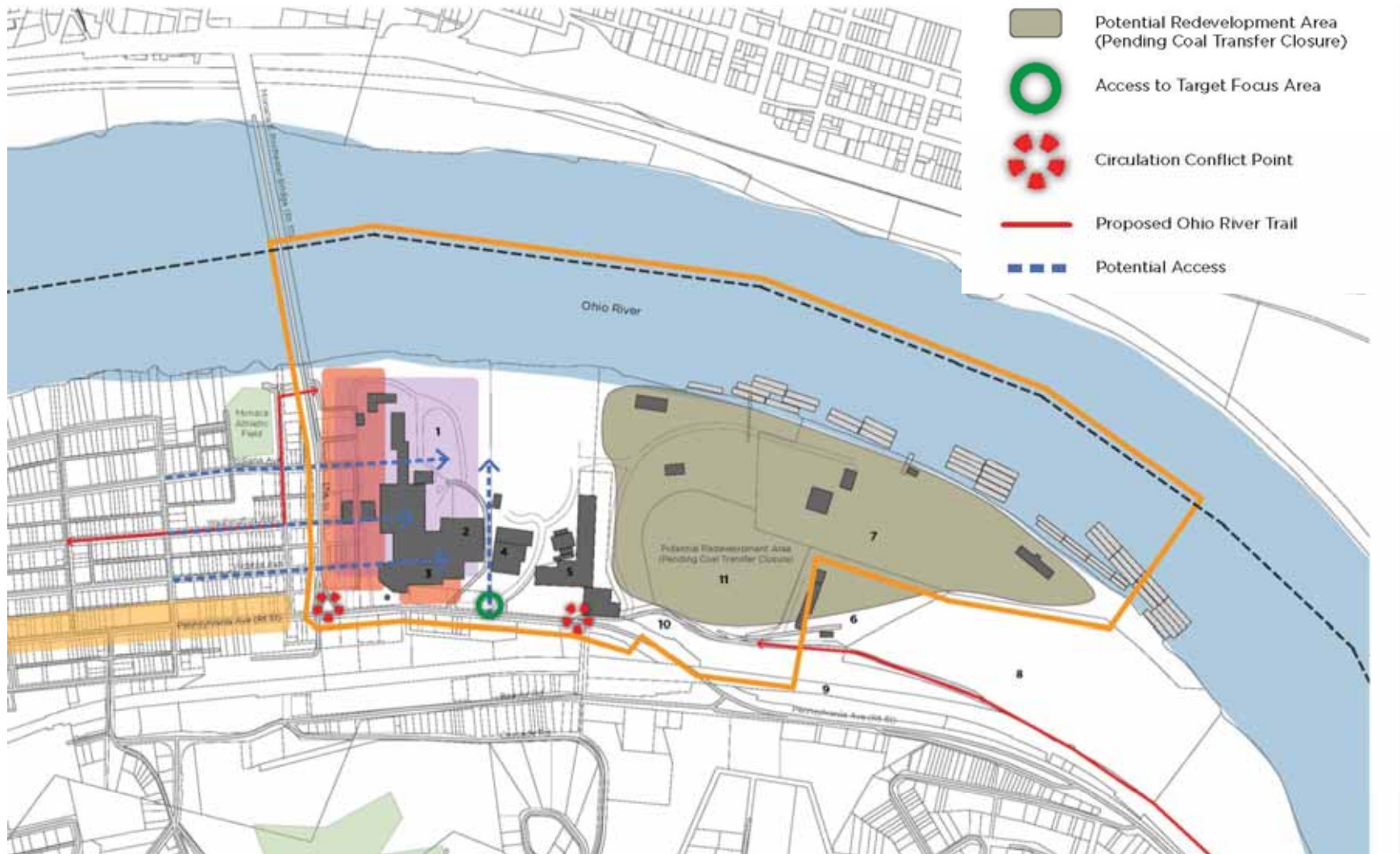
Planning Proposals and Priority Projects

- Improve 17th Street Gateway Corridor and intersection with roundabout and create proposed Monaca River Boulevard access to river.
- Promote first phase mixed-use infill redevelop between 17th Avenue and Monaca River Boulevard.
- Construction proposed Ohio River Trail from Monaca Field and along proposed Monaca River Boulevard.
- Partner with owner of Colona Steel site to promote mixed-use redevelopment and site improvements to support existing industrial.

Monaca Borough



Monaca –



LEGEND

- Traditional Main Street Redevelopment Corridor
- Target Focus Area
- Sub Focus Area
- Potential Redevelopment Area (Pending Coal Transfer Closure)
- Access to Target Focus Area
- Circulation Conflict Point
- Proposed Ohio River Trail
- Potential Access



Monaca –



Monaca –



Monaca –



City of Aliquippa



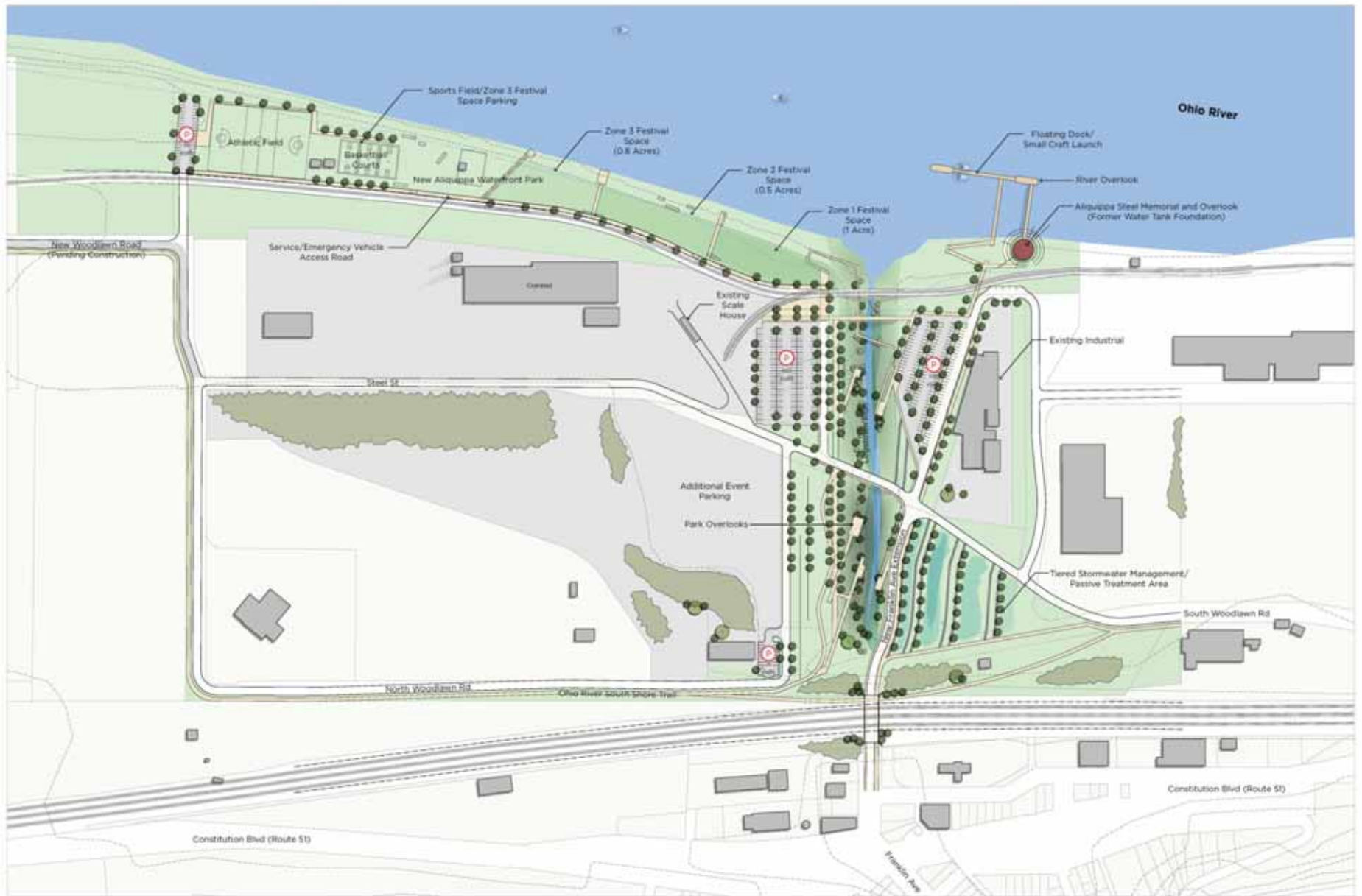
City of Aliquippa

Analysis Conclusions

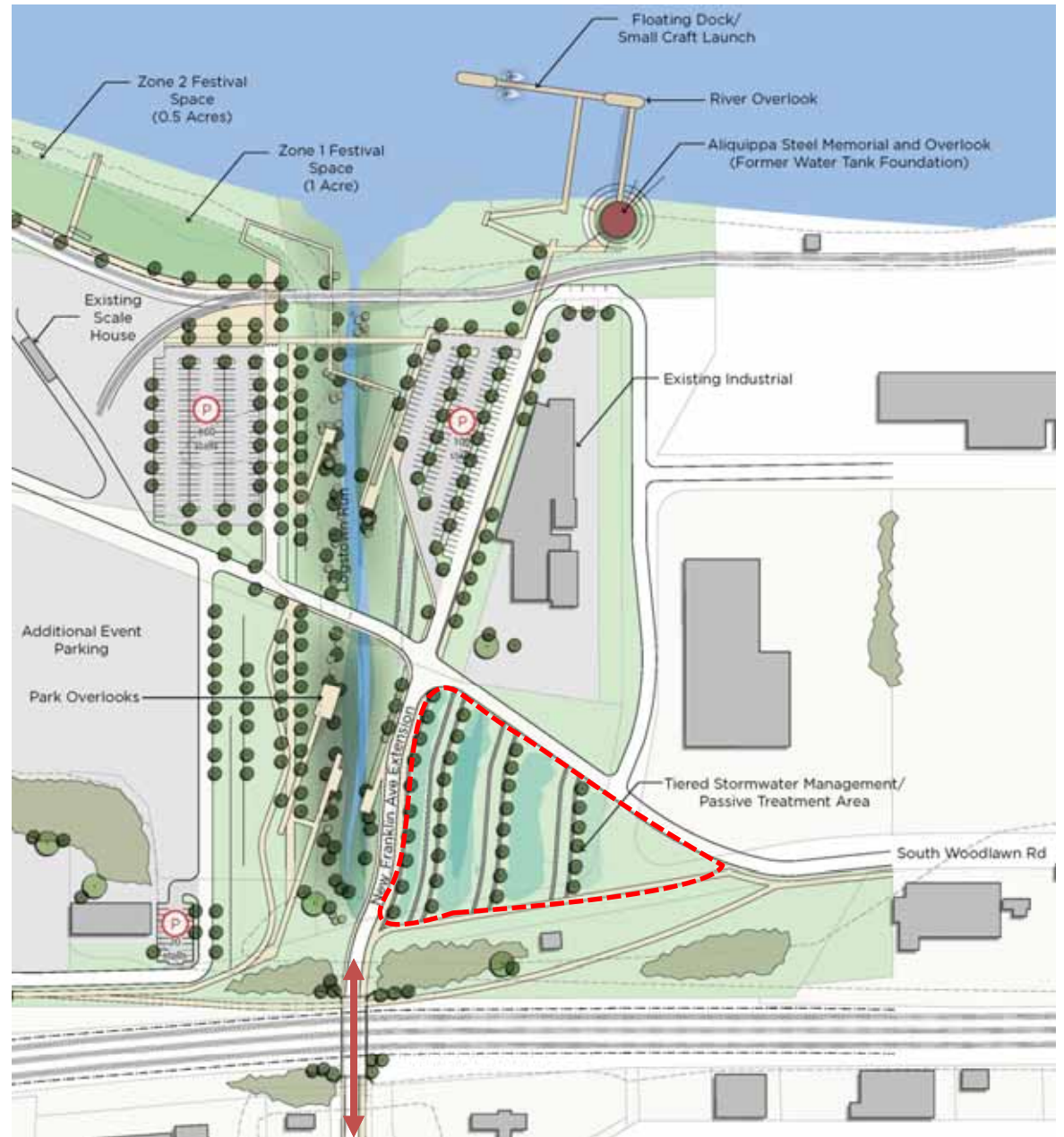
- Vehicular and pedestrian access to major industrial area and river hindered by deficient design of Franklin Avenue underpass.
- Community has strong desire to gain public access to river's edge and San Rocco festival looking for larger festival site.
- Industrial redevelopment is the main emphasis for the overall riverfront with the exception of the area adjacent to Logstown Run.
- Stormwater management and pre-treatment areas are needed (CSO), Logstown Run outfall severely impaired.
- BCED currently constructing major Woodlawn Road connector.

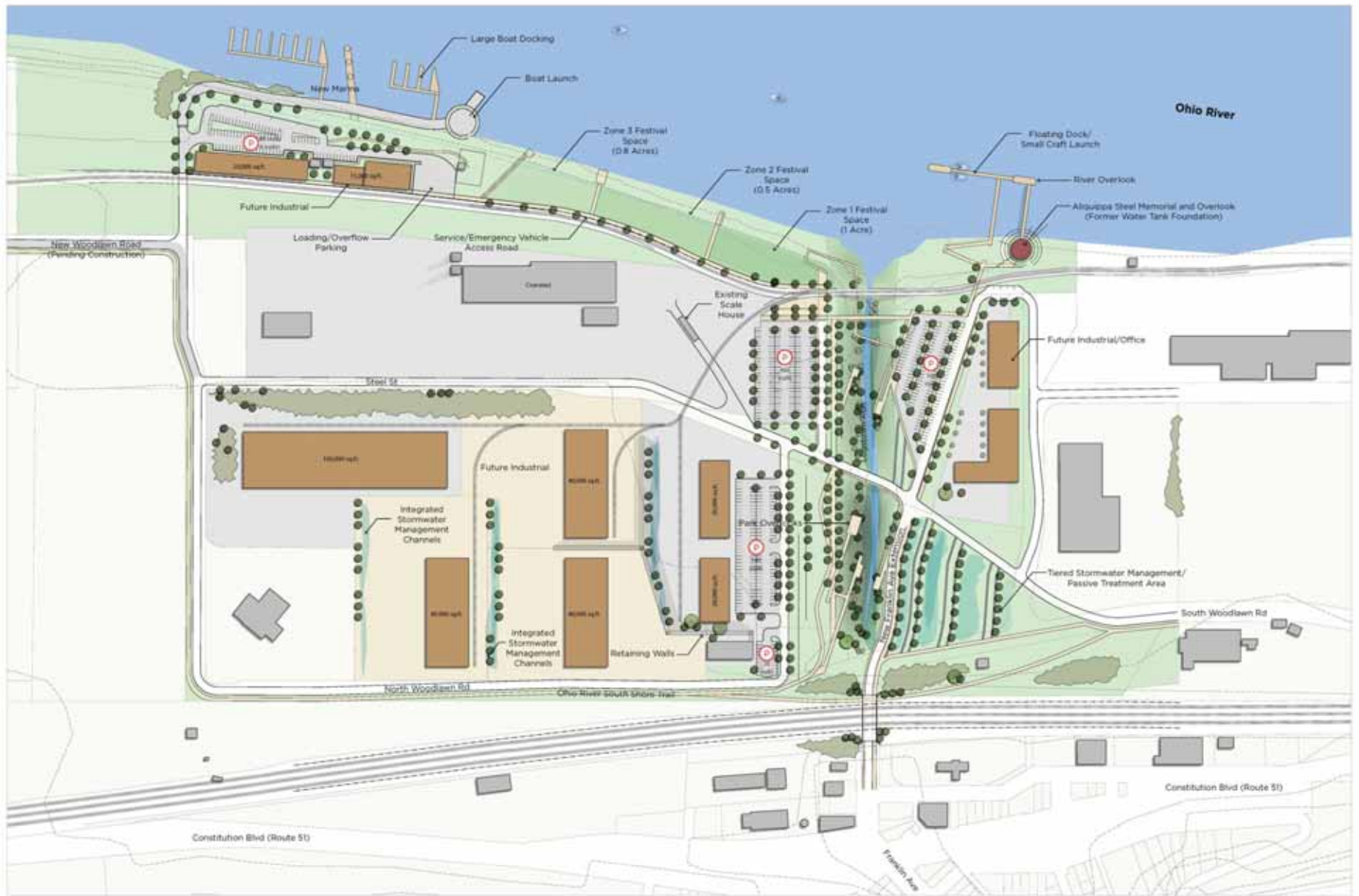
Planning Proposals and Priority Projects

- Acquire Logstown Run outfall and perform major habitat restoration, stormwater management improvements and public park connection to extend Franklin Avenue to the river with trail connection.
- Improve vehicular circulation from existing Franklin Avenue underpass into Cronimet property and Steel Street connection to remove turning conflicts at underpass.
- Work with BCED to create public festivals ground, boat launch and vehicular access on their riverfront property not suitable for industrial redevelopment and improve access
- Create defined parking areas to serve industrial uses during weekdays and public riverfront park parking during weekends and evening.

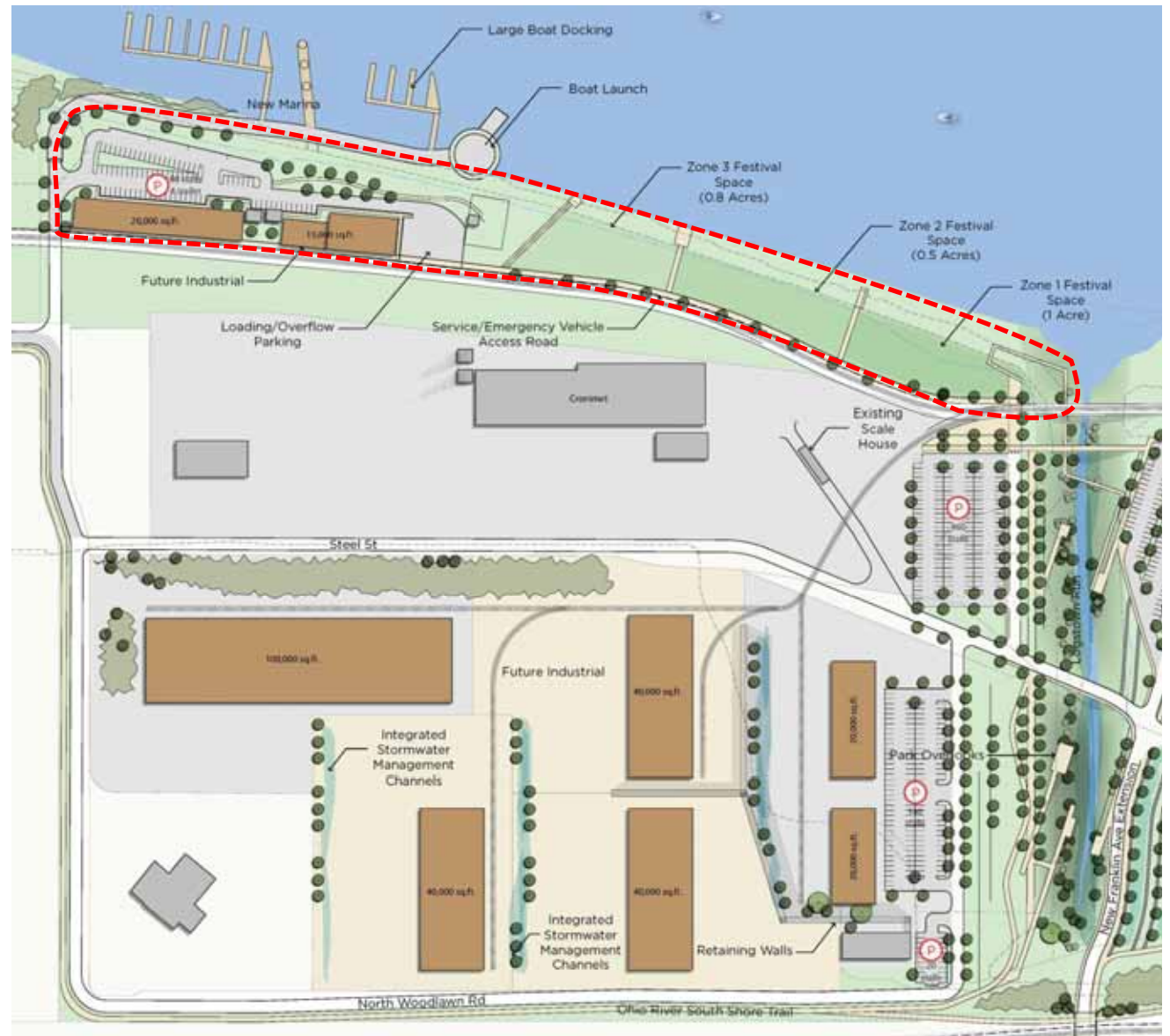


Aliquippa –





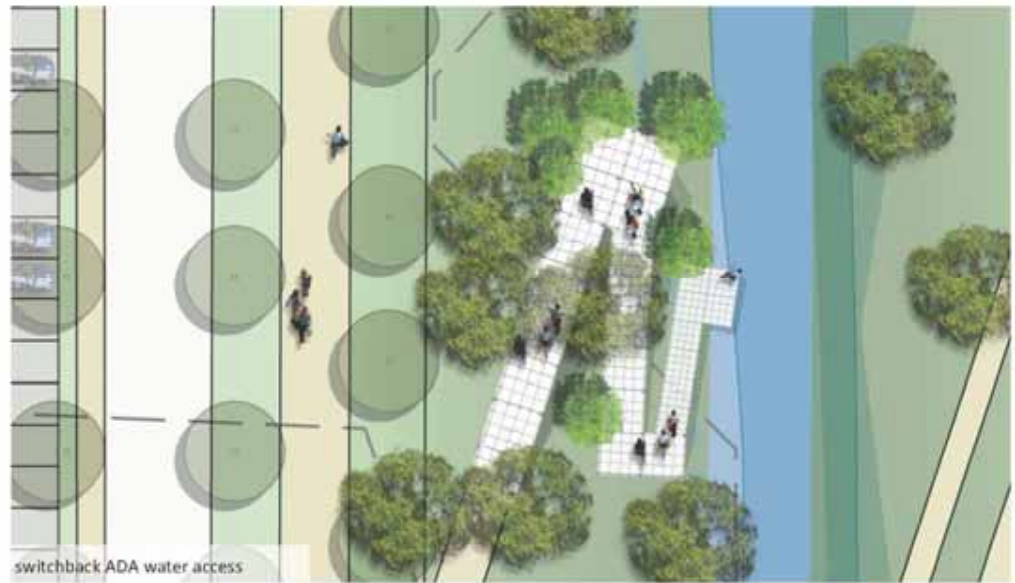
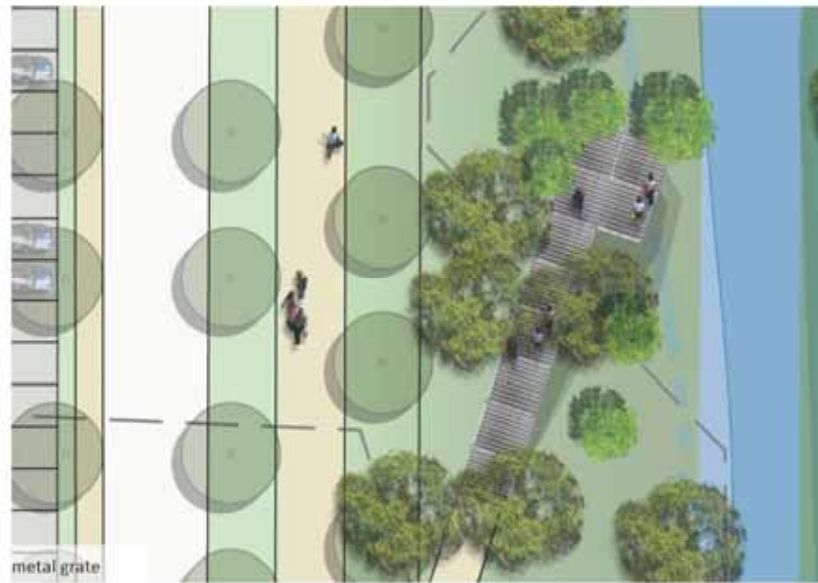
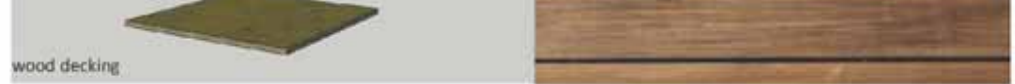
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Aliquippa –



decking and catwalk surface treatment options



Aliquippa –

Summer Concert Series

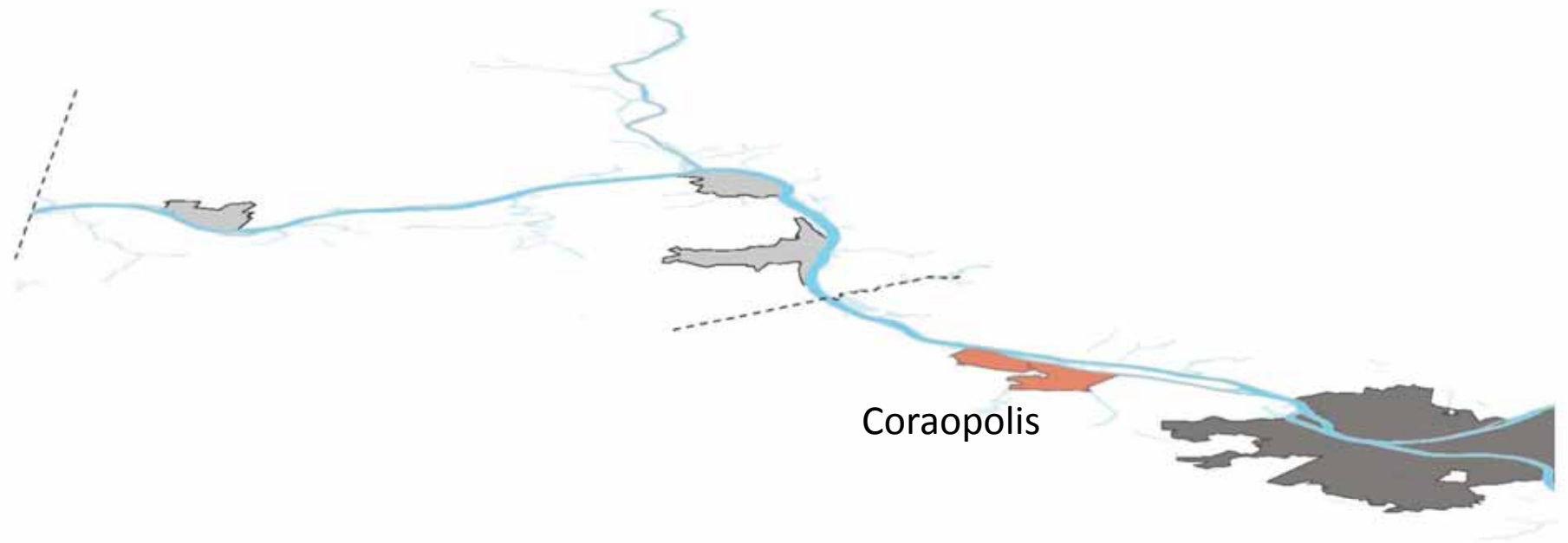


Aliquippa –

Festival Space



Coraopolis Borough



Coraopolis Borough – Riverfront and Station Areas

Analysis Conclusions

- Riverfront is at a very desirable location along Ohio River back channel for redevelopment. And key property owner is actively exploring development options.
- Robert Morris University has expressed an interest in create a strong presence in the town and has major recreation facility on Neville Island across the back channel from study area, including new rowing boathouse facility. RMU has a significant on campus housing shortage.
- Allegheny County proposing major recreation/soccer complex on adjacent riverfront site.
- Historic Station owned by Coraopolis Community Foundation and undertaking major capital campaign for restoration.
- Proposed Ohio River Trail runs adjacent or through both areas.
- Stormwater management and pre-treatment areas are needed (major CSO issues).

Planning Proposals and Priority Projects - Riverfront

- Create 3rd Avenue extension into riverfront site to support multi-family residential , park, boathouse/launch and Ohio River Trail.
- Support RMU/landowner discussions regarding boathouse project and potential student housing (both areas).

Planning Proposals and Priority Projects – Station Area

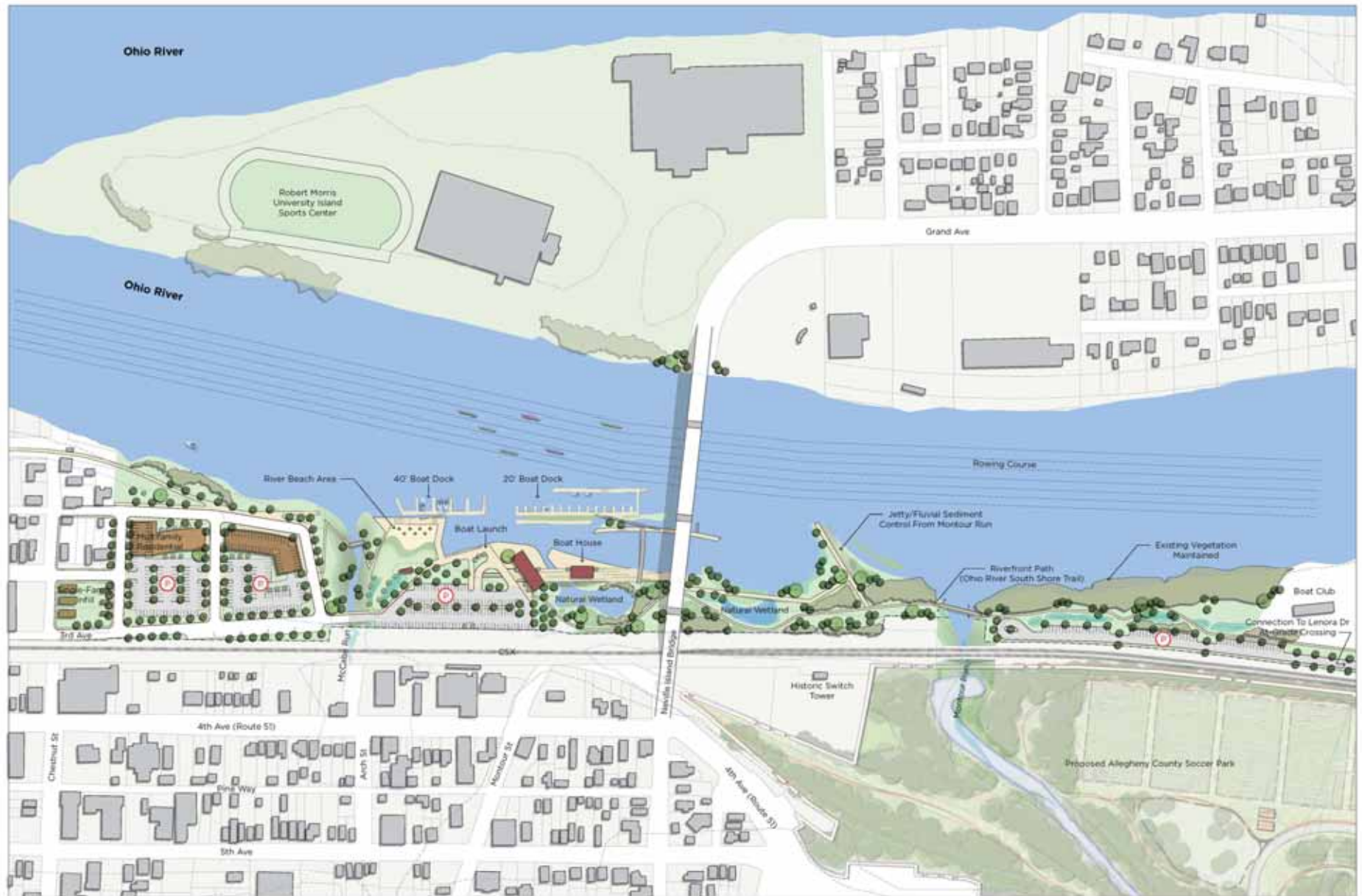
- Facilitate the create Neville Avenue Extension to serve station.
- Redevelop station as a regional transit and student shuttle multi modal hub.
- Assemble adjacent properties for mixed-use infill (student housing) and create town square.

Coraopolis – Riverfront



Coraopolis – Riverfront







Coraopolis – Station Area



Coraopolis – Station Area



Coraopolis – Station Area

